MENLO SCHOOL
PROFILE 2026-2027

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Menlo School is accredited by the Western Association of Schools and Colleges and is a member of the National and California Associations of Independent Schools.

THE SCHOOL

Established in 1915, Menlo School is a highly-selective independent, coeducational, college preparatory day school situated in the heart of Silicon Valley. The School inspires students to lead lives of meaning, impact, and joy. Through our relevant, responsive curriculum, students in grades 6-12 explore diverse points of view and are encouraged to think globally and act with compassion. Our talented educators lead with enthusiasm and curiosity, challenging students in their learning while ensuring the support each student needs to thrive. We believe that learning is a journey that should be enjoyed. Our students are encouraged to chart their own paths through a broad array of exceptional academic, artistic, and athletic programs that spark wonder and launch wider exploration.

MENLO BY THE NUMBERS

618
Student Population Grades 9-12

$7.6M
In Aid to
20%
of the Upper School Student Body

8:1
Student-to-Teacher Ratio

79
Advanced Classes Offered

22
Varsity Sports Offered

CLASS OF 2027 BY THE NUMBERS

Class size **141**

Mean GPA **3.82**

High GPA **4.37**

12
National Merit Semifinalists

GRADING AND CLASS RANK

In the Upper School, GPA is cumulative from freshman year using all courses with the exception of Physical Education (PE). Menlo reports yearlong grades, with the exception of a few electives where semester grades are reported on the weighted and cumulative transcript. Plus and minus grades are weighted (e.g., B+= 3.33, B-= 2.67). **Upper School students receive an extra .5 of credit for each Honors (H), Advanced Placement (AP), or Advanced Topics course, as all three designations are considered equally rigorous.** Students are not ranked.

As of August 2024, Menlo has discontinued the AP Curriculum and replaced it with more relevant, rigorous Honors and Advanced Topics offerings. AP Physics 2 was the only AP course offered from 2024 to 2025, it is now Physics 2 (H).

When requested by a college or university to which a student has applied, Menlo School will report incidents that occurred in grades 9 through 12 that resulted in the student being dismissed, suspended, or placed on citizenship probation. Menlo School will also report voluntary withdrawals when disciplinary action is possible or pending whenever such information is requested by a college or university.

DISTINCTIVE PROGRAMS AND COURSES

Applied Science Research (ASR)
ASR is a capstone class. Students learn how to design and build something, do experiments, analyze and graph their data, and compute the errors on their experiments. Students work on campus and/or intern at a local university or company under a mentor. At the conclusion of the second semester, each student writes a science or engineering paper, gives a final presentation, and has the opportunity to publish their work in a science or engineering journal.

BioTech Research
BioTech Research is a capstone class. Students learn key lab techniques in molecular biology, protein biochemistry, immunolocalization, and cell culture. They then use these skills to design and carry out an authentic, independent research project, either in our lab or in a local industry or academic lab.

Catalyst: Applied Leadership Semester
The Catalyst Semester is a selective, immersive leadership program for a cohort of up to 18 juniors each semester. Through rigorous, cross-disciplinary coursework grounded in systems thinking, students examine complex, real-world challenges through the lens of a changing climate while building their capacity to lead and navigate complexity. Fieldwork and collaboration with experts and community partners extend learning beyond the classroom and form the basis of semester-long capstone research projects in which students put their ideas and learning into action.

Global Online Academy (GOA)
Students may take online courses through GOA, a consortium of independent schools worldwide, for Menlo credit, with course grades calculated into their GPA.

Menlo Interdisciplinary and Personalized Scholars Program (IP)
This interdisciplinary capstone program gives students the agency to chart an ambitious course of study around their interests. Scholars explore complex societal challenges and their own novel ideas, producing significant original work ranging from scholarly research and creative projects to documentary films and nonprofit initiatives. The experience culminates in a formal presentation and thesis defense before a faculty panel.

Menlo Abroad
Three-week international travel programs that feature facilitated curricula, service-learning, language immersion, and homestays. Students develop meaningful relationships with people in distant places, make friends, and use their skills to address common problems. Current offerings include Malaysia, Costa Rica, Peru, and Tanzania.

Borderlands
Immersive one-week domestic travel opportunities to the Southwest or Native American communities near Lake Superior to study Indigenous America, immigration, and sustainability.

MTerm
A two-week immersive learning experience held each May after the conclusion of the core curriculum. Through hands-on mini-courses rooted in local and global citizenship, students deepen their understanding of complex issues, engage with communities beyond campus, and consider their role in the wider world. Topics include sustainability, criminal justice, poverty, homelessness, and social entrepreneurship.

COLLEGE MATRICULATION FOR THE MEMBERS OF THE CLASSES OF 2024-2026

Amherst College **2**
Babson College **1**
Barnard College **4**
Bates College **1**
Baylor University **1**
Boston College **16**
Boston University **6**
Brandeis University **1**
Brigham Young University **1**
Brown University **4**
Bryn Mawr College **1**
Bucknell University **1**
California Institute of Technology **1**
California Lutheran University **1**
California Polytechnic State University San Luis Obispo **3**
California State University Long Beach **1**
Carleton College **1**
Carnegie Mellon University **4**
Case Western Reserve University **2**
Chapman University **10**
Claremont McKenna College **1**
Colby College **1**
Colgate University **5**
Colorado College **5**
Columbia University **5**
Cornell University **8**
Dartmouth College **7**
Davidson College **1**
De Anza College **2**
Duke University **8**
Emerson College **1**
Emory University **2**
Emory University - Oxford **1**
Foothill College **1**
George Washington University **1**
Georgetown University **8**
Georgia Institute of Technology **1**
Grinnell College **1**
Hamilton College **2**
Harvard University **6**
Harvey Mudd College **1**
Lafayette College **1**
Lehigh University **5**
Loyola Marymount University **5**
Loyola University Chicago **2**
Massachusetts Institute of Technology **3**
Middlebury College **3**
New York University **9**
Northeastern University **6**
Northwestern University **13**
Occidental College **4**
Pepperdine University **1**
Pitzer College **1**
Pomona College **2**
Princeton University **4**
Purdue University **2**
Reed College **1**
Rice University **4**
Rutgers University **1**
San Diego State University **1**
San Francisco State University **1**
San Jose State University **1**
Santa Clara University **8**
Scripps College **4**
Skidmore College **2**
Smith College **1**
Southern Methodist University **3**
Stanford University **41**
Syracuse University **2**
Texas Christian University **1**
The Ohio State University **1**
The University of Texas at Austin **2**
Tufts University **6**
Tulane University of Louisiana **18**
Union College **1**
United States Military Academy at West Point **2**
University of British Columbia **1**
University of California Berkeley **17**
University of California Davis **2**
University of California Irvine **2**
University of California Los Angeles **9**
University of California Merced **2**
University of California Santa Barbara **2**
University of California Santa Cruz **3**
University of Chicago **15**
University of Colorado Boulder **4**
University of Denver **3**
University of Hong Kong **1**
University of Miami **2**
University of Michigan **9**
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill **1**
University of Notre Dame **3**
University of Pennsylvania **2**
University of Puget Sound **1**
University of Redlands **1**
University of San Diego **1**
University of Southern California **13**
University of St Andrews **1**
University of Toronto **1**
University of Utah **1**
University of Washington Seattle Campus **7**
University of Waterloo **1**
University of Wisconsin Madison **5**
Vanderbilt University **10**
Villanova University **3**
Wake Forest University **3**
Washington University in St. Louis **13**
Wellesley College **5**
Whitman College **2**
William & Mary **1**
Williams College **4**
Yale University **3**

COURSE OFFERINGS US *Upper* School

ENGLISH
4 years required

English 1, 2

Junior English Seminars

Literature
Literature H
Rhetoric H
Rhetoric

Advanced English Seminars
This list represents our current Advanced English Seminar offerings and may change from year to year.

5 Months, 4 Books
A Literary Exploration of Delight
Cafe Society
Climate Fiction and Solarpunk: From Warning to Hope 2S H
Contemporary World Literature
Creative Nonfiction Workshop H
Dystopian Fiction & Film
Freaks H
Global Mythologies
Gothic Literature
How to Read a Big Novel
How to Write a Love Story
Investigations
Literature of the American Wilderness H
Literature in the Age of AI
Magical Realism and Horror H
Medicine & Narrative
Modernist Poetry Workshop H
On Being
Shakespeare Now H
Science Fiction & the Classics H
State of the Art: Extremely Contemporary Writing H

Beginning in 2024-25, all juniors are placed into either a junior English Seminar in Rhetoric or Literature in their first semester. Second semester, they choose an Advanced English Seminar. All seniors take at least two Advanced English Seminars, which are equally rigorous and in-depth, with a few honors offerings.

HISTORY & SOCIAL SCIENCES
3 years required

Modern World History
U.S. History
U.S. History H
Adv. Topics in History: Government and Politics H
Adv. Topics in History: Modern Europe H

Advanced History Seminars
This list represents our current Advanced History Seminar offerings and may change from year to year.

American Economic History
California History
Economic Theory
Ethnic Studies I
Humanities I: Renaissances
In Gods We Trust
Philosophy I
Political Philosophy and the Modern World
Psychology: Foundations
Pursuit of Happiness: The Psychology, Anthropology, & Philosophy of Happiness
War and Gender
Current Affairs & Civil Discourse
Environmental and Development Economics
Ethnic Studies II
Global Issues for Global Citizens
History of U.S. Foreign Relations
Humanities II: Self-Portraits
Modern Japan
Philosophy II
Psychology: Development, Personality, and Mental Disorders

Our history seminars are designed to be rigorous and include in-depth studies of various topics. All include an Honors option.

MATHEMATICS
3 years required

Adv. Topics in Math H
Adv. Calculus I H
Adv. Calculus II H
Algebra 2
Algebra 2 with Trigonometry
Algebra 2 with Trigonometry H
Analytic Geometry & Algebra
Analytic Geometry & Algebra H
Applied Math & Statistics: Business Applications
Calculus
Integrated Geometry & Algebra
Introductory Calculus
Introductory Calculus H
Pre-Calculus
Probabilistic Modeling & Machine Learning H

COMPUTER SCIENCE

CS1: Intro to Computer Science*
CS2: Data Structures & Algorithms H
Adv. Topics in CompSci H
Coding with AI

**CS1 is Pass/Fail only*

SCIENCE
3 years required

Conceptual Physics
Physics 1
Chemistry
Chemistry H
Living Systems: Biology in Balance
Molecular Mechanisms in Biology
Adv. Topics in Biology H
Adv. Topics in Chemistry H
Adv. Topics in Physics: Quantum Mechanics H
Adv. Topics in Physics: Electromagnetism & Relativity H
Anatomy & Physiology
Applied Science Research H
BioTech Research H
Design and Architecture
Environmental Science
Experimental Archaeology
Mechanical/Electrical Engineering
Mechatronics
Neuroscience
Sustainable Engineering
Physics 2 H

WORLD LANGUAGES
2 or 3 years required, based on starting placement

French 1, 2, 3, 4 H
Adv. Topics in French: Hidden Voices of the Francophone World H
Latin 1, 2, 3 H, 4
Adv. Topics in Latin: Intro to Literature H
Adv. Topics in Latin: Love & Friendship H
Spanish 1, 2, 3, 4 H
Heritage Spanish 3
Adv. Topics in Spanish: Language and Culture Through Documentary Film H
Mandarin 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 H
Adv. Topics in Mandarin: Survey of Mandarin Speaking Countries and Communities through Chinese Cinema H

CREATIVE ARTS
2 years required

Art Foundations
Advanced Art
Adv. Topics in Art H
Fundamentals of Photography
Adv. Photography
Adv. Topics in Photography: Portfolio H
Chamber Orchestra
Jazz Band
How Music Works
Push Play
Adv. Topics in Music Theories H
Knight Singers
Advanced Vocal Technique & Performance
Adv. Topics: Vocal Performance H
Dance Foundations
Advanced Dance
Fundamentals of Media Production
Advanced Media Production
Adv. Topics in Media Production: Portfolio H
Drama
Fundamentals of Yearbook
Advanced Yearbook
Yearbook Leadership

JOURNALISM

Fundamentals of Journalism
Advanced Journalism
Journalism Leadership H

ELECTIVES

Social Psych: Relationships and Groups
Social Psych: Influence and Motivation

INTERDISCIPLINARY & PERSONALIZED (IP) SCHOLARS

The IP provides an opportunity for students to examine root causes of societal problems, envision possible solutions to said challenges, and supports them in creating their own original work or producing original scholarly criticism.

CATALYST APPLIED LEADERSHIP SEMESTER

Leadership Seminar: Igniting Change H
Advanced English Seminar: Multimedia Narratives for Impact H
Advanced History Seminar: Past Crises, Present Solutions H
Biology: Field Research
Applied Science: Engineering for Extremes
Math: Pre-Calculus or Introductory Calculus H
World Languages: Optional Elective

FRESHMAN SEMINAR PROGRAM *Required*

ADDITIONAL GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

MTerm
Life Beyond Menlo Senior Programming
Community Engagement
Physical Education

GLOBAL ONLINE ACADEMY

H = Honors Course or Honors Option

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